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United States Patent	12405491
Kind Code	B2
Date of Patent	September 02, 2025
Inventor(s)	Dou; Hu et al.

Viewing angle adjustment film structure, manufacturing method thereof, and display device

Abstract

Disclosed are a viewing angle adjustment film structure, a manufacturing method thereof, and a display device, including a base, an isotropic optical material layer, and a liquid crystal layer stacked in sequence. The isotropic optical material layer is provided with grooves, the liquid crystal layer fills the grooves, and light enters from the liquid crystal layer and then exits through the isotropic optical material layer. Director of liquid crystal molecules in the liquid crystal layer is changed according to an external applied voltage or a change of an electric field, so as to adjust a viewing angle of the light emitted from the isotropic optical material layer.

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Appl. No.: 18/421873

Filed: January 24, 2024

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier	Publication Date
US 20240160053 A1	May. 16, 2024

Foreign Application Priority Data

CN	202010626734.6	Jul. 02, 2020
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Related U.S. Application Data

continuation parent-doc US 17049966 US 11914235 WO PCT/CN2020/106684 20200804 child-doc US 18421873

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: **G02F1/1333** (20060101); **G02F1/13** (20060101); **G02F1/13363** (20060101);
G02F1/1337 (20060101); **G02F1/1347** (20060101); **G02F1/137** (20060101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC **G02F1/1323** (20130101); **G02F1/133377** (20130101); **G02F1/13363** (20130101);
G02F1/133738 (20210101); **G02F1/13471** (20130101); **G02F1/137** (20130101);

Field of Classification Search

CPC: G02F (1/1323); G02F (1/133377); G02F (1/133738)

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application is a continuation application of U.S. application Ser. No. 17/049,966, filed on Oct. 23, 2020, which is a National Phase of PCT Patent Application No. PCT/CN2020/106684 having international filing date of Aug. 4, 2020, which claims the priority of Chinese Application No. 202010626734.6 filed with the Chinese Patent Office on Jul. 2, 2020 and titled “VIEWING ANGLE ADJUSTMENT FILM STRUCTURE, MANUFACTURING METHOD THEREOF, AND DISPLAY DEVICE”, which is incorporated herein by reference in its entirety.

FIELD OF INVENTION

(1) The present application relates to the field of display technologies, and more particularly to a viewing angle adjustment film structure, a manufacturing method thereof, and a display device.

BACKGROUND OF INVENTION

(2) With a rapid development of display technologies, a market has higher and higher requirements for resolution of display panels. The higher the resolution of the display panel, the worse the display brightness of the corresponding display panel. Therefore, the display brightness of a large viewing angle decreases. Technical issues urgently needed to be solved for ultra-high-definition display panels.

(3) In the prior art, a viewing angle diffuser film is used to modulate light of a front viewing angle to a large viewing angle, so as to increase the display brightness of the display panel at the large viewing angle. However, this will result in a loss of the display brightness of the front viewing angle of the display panel and substantial reduction in the contrast of the front viewing angle, and an issue of deterioration of display image quality may occur when the display panel is viewed from the front viewing angle.

SUMMARY OF INVENTION

(4) The present application provides a viewing angle adjustment film structure, a manufacturing method thereof, and a display device so as to solve an issue that a current viewing angle diffusion film reduces a front viewing angle display brightness and a front viewing angle contrast of a current display panel, which leads to an issue of deterioration of display quality when viewing the current display panel from a front viewing angle.

(5) In a first aspect, an embodiment of the present application provides a viewing angle adjustment film structure. The viewing angle adjustment film structure comprises a base, an isotropic optical material layer, and a liquid crystal layer stacked in sequence. The isotropic optical material layer is provided with grooves, the liquid crystal layer fills the grooves, and light enters from the liquid crystal layer and then exits through the isotropic optical material layer. Director of liquid crystal molecules in the liquid crystal layer is changed according to an external applied voltage or a change of an electric field, so as to adjust a viewing angle of the light emitted from the isotropic optical material layer. When the director is parallel to the base, a refractive index of the liquid crystal layer is the same as a refractive index of the isotropic optical material layer; when the director is perpendicular to the base, the refractive index of the liquid crystal layer is less than the refractive index of the isotropic optical material layer.

(6) In an embodiment, the viewing angle adjustment film structure according further comprises a first electrode and a second electrode, the first electrode is disposed between the base and the isotropic optical material layer, the second electrode is arranged on a side of the liquid crystal layer away from the isotropic optical material layer, and the external applied voltage or the electric field is provided to the liquid crystal layer through the first electrode and the second electrode.

(7) In an embodiment, the viewing angle adjustment film structure further comprises a first alignment film and a second alignment film, the first alignment film is disposed between the isotropic optical material layer and the liquid crystal layer, and the second alignment film is disposed between the liquid crystal layer and the second electrode.

(8) In an embodiment, the viewing angle adjustment film structure further comprises a supporting pad disposed between the isotropic optical material layer and the second electrode, and the supporting pad penetrates the liquid crystal layer.

(9) In an embodiment, a number of the grooves is multiple, and the multiple grooves are arranged at equal intervals.

(10) In an embodiment, the grooves are strip-shaped grooves, and the multiple strip-shaped grooves are arranged at equal intervals in parallel.

(11) In an embodiment, a cross-section of the groove perpendicular to the base is a geometric shape with symmetrical left and right sides, and a width of the cross section gradually increases in a direction away from the base.

(12) In an embodiment, a cross-sectional shape of the groove is an isosceles trapezoid, a U-shape, or a circular arc with a central angle not greater than 180 degrees.

(13) In a second aspect, an embodiment of the present application provides a manufacturing method of a viewing angle adjustment film structure. The manufacturing method of a viewing angle adjustment film structure comprises providing a base; forming an isotropic optical material layer on the base, wherein the isotropic optical material layer is provided with grooves; and forming a liquid crystal layer on the isotropic optical material layer, wherein the liquid crystal layer fills the grooves, light enters from the liquid crystal layer and then exits through the isotropic optical material layer. Director of liquid crystal molecules in the liquid crystal layer is changed according to an external applied voltage or a change of an electric field, so as to adjust a viewing angle of the light emitted from the isotropic optical material layer. When the director is parallel to the base, a refractive index of the liquid crystal layer is the same as a refractive index of the isotropic optical material layer; when the director is perpendicular to the base, the refractive index of the liquid crystal layer is less than the refractive index of the isotropic optical material layer.

(14) In an embodiment, before forming the isotropic optical material layer on the base, the manufacturing method of the viewing angle adjustment film structure further comprises forming a first electrode on the base. The manufacturing method of the viewing angle adjustment film structure further comprises forming a second electrode on a substrate. The second electrode is fixed on the liquid crystal layer through the substrate, the second electrode is disposed between the liquid crystal layer and the isotropic optical material layer, and the external applied voltage or the electric field is provided to the liquid crystal layer through the first electrode and the second electrode.

(15) In an embodiment, before forming the liquid crystal layer on the isotropic optical material layer, the manufacturing method of the viewing angle adjustment film structure further comprises forming a first alignment film on the isotropic optical material layer. Before fixing the second electrode on the liquid crystal layer through the substrate, the manufacturing method of the viewing angle adjustment film structure further comprises forming a second alignment film on the second electrode.

(16) In an embodiment, before fixing the second electrode on the liquid crystal layer through the substrate, the manufacturing method of the viewing angle adjustment film structure further comprises forming a supporting pad on the isotropic optical material layer, wherein the supporting pad is disposed between the isotropic optical material layer and the second electrode, and the supporting pad penetrates the liquid crystal layer.

(17) In a third aspect, an embodiment of the present application provides a display device. The display device comprises the viewing angle adjustment film structure of any one of the above and a display panel. The viewing angle adjustment film structure is disposed on a light emitting surface of the display panel, and a viewing angle of light emitted from the light emitting surface is adjusted by the viewing angle adjustment film structure, so as to realize a front viewing angle display and a large viewing angle display of the display panel. The viewing angle adjustment film structure comprises a base, an isotropic optical material layer, and a liquid crystal layer stacked in sequence, the isotropic optical material layer is provided with grooves, the liquid crystal layer fills the grooves, and light enters from the liquid crystal layer and then exits through the isotropic optical material layer; director of liquid crystal molecules in the liquid crystal layer is changed according to an external applied voltage or a change of an electric field, so as to adjust a viewing angle of the light emitted from the isotropic optical material layer. When the director is parallel to the base, a refractive index of the liquid crystal layer is the same as a refractive index of the isotropic optical material layer; when the director is perpendicular to the base, the refractive index of the liquid crystal layer is less than the refractive index of the isotropic optical material layer.

(18) In an embodiment, the viewing angle adjustment film structure further comprises a first electrode and a second electrode, the first electrode is disposed between the base and the isotropic optical material layer, the second electrode is arranged on a side of the liquid crystal layer away from the isotropic optical material layer, and the external applied voltage or the electric field is provided to the liquid crystal layer through the first electrode and the second electrode.

- (19) In an embodiment, the viewing angle adjustment film structure further comprises a first alignment film and a second alignment film, the first alignment film is disposed between the isotropic optical material layer and the liquid crystal layer, and the second alignment film is disposed between the liquid crystal layer and the second electrode.
- (20) In an embodiment, the viewing angle adjustment film structure further comprises a supporting pad disposed between the isotropic optical material layer and the second electrode, and the supporting pad penetrates the liquid crystal layer.
- (21) In an embodiment, a number of the grooves is multiple, and the multiple grooves are arranged at equal intervals.
- (22) In an embodiment, the grooves are strip-shaped grooves, and the multiple strip-shaped grooves are arranged at equal intervals in parallel.
- (23) In an embodiment, a cross-section of the groove perpendicular to the base is a geometric shape with symmetrical left and right sides, and a width of the cross section gradually increases in a direction away from the base.
- (24) In an embodiment, the display panel comprises a color filter substrate, an array substrate arranged opposite to the color filter substrate and provided with a plurality of pixel units, and a liquid crystal material layer filled between the color filter substrate and the array substrate, a first polarizer disposed on a side of the color filter substrate away from the liquid crystal material layer, and a second polarizer disposed on a side of the array substrate away from the liquid crystal material layer. The viewing angle adjustment film structure is disposed on a side of the first polarizer away from the color filter substrate, and light emitted by the pixel units in the array substrate exits through the liquid crystal material layer, the color filter substrate, the first polarizer, the base, the liquid crystal layer, and the isotropic light material layer in sequence.

Beneficial Effect

(25) Compared with the prior art, the viewing angle adjustment film structure provided by the present application includes a base, an isotropic optical material layer, and a liquid crystal layer stacked in sequence, the isotropic optical material layer is provided with grooves, the liquid crystal layer fills the grooves, and light enters from the liquid crystal layer and then exits through the isotropic optical material layer. Director of liquid crystal molecules in the liquid crystal layer is changed according to an external applied voltage or a change of an electric field. In this way, when it is necessary to increase brightness of the light with a large viewing angle, the externally applied voltage or electric field can be controlled to make the director of the liquid crystal molecules perpendicular to the base. A refractive index of the corresponding liquid crystal layer is less than a refractive index of the isotropic optical material layer. When it is necessary to ensure that brightness of the light at a front viewing angle is not affected, the external applied voltage or electric field can also be controlled to make the director of the liquid crystal molecules parallel to the base. The refractive index of the corresponding liquid crystal layer is equal to the refractive index of the isotropic optical material layer, thereby ensuring that brightness and contrast of light under front viewing angles are not reduced. As a result, the viewing angle adjustment film structure can cope with complex use environment requirements, and the viewing angle adjustment film structure is used to replace a current viewing angle diffusion film. This can solve issues of deterioration of display image quality when viewing the display panel from the front viewing angle due to reduction of front viewing angle display brightness and front viewing angle contrast of the display panel by a current viewing angle diffusion film.

Description

DESCRIPTION OF DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1 is a schematic structural diagram of a viewing angle adjustment film structure provided

by an embodiment of the present application.

(2) FIG. 2 is a schematic diagram of effect of adjusting a viewing angle of light by a viewing angle adjustment film structure provided by an embodiment of the present application.

(3) FIG. 3 is another schematic diagram of effect of adjusting a viewing angle of light by a viewing angle adjustment film structure provided by an embodiment of the present application.

(4) FIG. 4 is a schematic diagram of distribution position of grooves on an isotropic light material layer provided by an embodiment of the present application.

(5) FIG. 5 is another structural diagram of a viewing angle adjustment film structure provided by an embodiment of the present application.

(6) FIG. 6 is another structural diagram of a viewing angle adjustment film structure provided by an embodiment of the present application.

(7) FIG. 7 is a schematic diagram of a structure of a liquid crystal layer provided by an embodiment of the present application.

(8) FIG. 8 is a schematic flowchart of a manufacturing method of a viewing angle adjustment film structure provided by an embodiment of the present application.

(9) FIG. 9 is a schematic structural diagram of a display device provided by an embodiment of the present application.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF PREFERRED EMBODIMENTS

(10) The present application will be further described in detail below with reference to the drawings and embodiments. It is particularly pointed out that the following examples are only used to illustrate the present application, but do not limit the scope of the present application. Likewise, the following embodiments are only part of the embodiments of the present application, but not all embodiments. All other embodiments obtained by a person of ordinary skill in the art without creative work shall fall within the protection scope of the present application.

(11) Referring to FIG. 1 to FIG. 3, FIG. 1 is a schematic structural diagram of a viewing angle adjustment film structure provided by an embodiment of the present application, FIG. 2 is a schematic diagram of effect of adjusting a viewing angle of light by a viewing angle adjustment film structure provided by an embodiment of the present application, and FIG. 3 is another schematic diagram of effect of adjusting a viewing angle of light by a viewing angle adjustment film structure provided by an embodiment of the present application. As illustrated in FIG. 1 to FIG. 3, the viewing angle adjustment film structure **100** includes a base **101**, an isotropic optical material layer **102**, and a liquid crystal layer **103** that are sequentially stacked. Grooves **1021** are provided on the isotropic optical material layer **102**. The liquid crystal layer **103** fills the grooves **1021**. Light L from the outside (for example, a light emitting surface of a display panel) enters the liquid crystal layer **103** and then exits through the isotropic optical material layer **102**.

(12) In this embodiment, as illustrated in FIG. 2 and FIG. 3, the above-mentioned liquid crystal layer **103** includes a plurality of liquid crystal molecules **1031**, and director of the liquid crystal molecules **1031** in the liquid crystal layer **103** will be changed according to change in external applied voltage or electric field to adjust a viewing angle of the light L emitted from the isotropic optical material layer **102**. Specifically, when the director of the liquid crystal molecules **1031** in the liquid crystal layer **103** is parallel to the base **101**, as shown in FIG. 2, a refractive index of the liquid crystal layer **103** is the same as a refractive index of the isotropic optical material layer **102**. The corresponding light L entering from the liquid crystal layer **103** will not be refracted at an interface of the isotropic optical material layer **102**, that is, the viewing angle adjustment film structure **100** will not affect brightness and contrast of the light L at a front viewing angle. Further, when the director of the liquid crystal molecules **1031** in the liquid crystal layer **103** is perpendicular to the base **101**, as shown in FIG. 3, the refractive index of the liquid crystal layer **103** is smaller than the refractive index of the isotropic optical material layer **102**. Correspondingly, at least part of the light L (for example, incident light at a front viewing angle) incident from the liquid crystal layer **103** will be refracted at the interface of the isotropic optical material layer **103**.

Therefore, at least part of the incident light from the front viewing angle can be adjusted to light with a large viewing angle, so as to enhance brightness of the light under the large viewing angle. Light with a large viewing angle may refer to light with a viewing angle greater than a preset angle (for example, 45 degrees). Light with a front viewing angle may refer to a light with a viewing angle less than a preset angle (for example, 20 degrees).

(13) During specific implementation, a suitable external applied voltage or electric field can be selected according to actual use scene requirements of the above-mentioned viewing angle adjustment film structure **100**. The viewing angle adjustment film structure **100** uses a viewing angle to increase brightness of the light L at a large viewing angle by sacrificing brightness and contrast of the light L at a front viewing angle. Alternatively, the viewing angle adjustment film structure **100** is not used to increase the brightness of the light L at a large viewing angle, thereby ensuring that the brightness and contrast of the light L at a front viewing angle are not reduced. In this way, the viewing angle adjustment film structure **100** in the present application can cope with the requirements of a complex use environment.

(14) The base **101** may be a transparent flexible base such as a polyimide or polysiloxane base, or a transparent rigid base such as a glass or plastic base. Material of the isotropic optical material layer **102** may be UV curable resin or thermosetting resin such as epoxy resin, acrylic resin, urethane resin, silicone resin, or phenol resin. Material of the liquid crystal layer **103** can be a nematic liquid crystal material or a blue phase liquid crystal material. Moreover, when shape of the liquid crystal molecules **1031** in the liquid crystal layer **103** is an elliptical sphere (as shown in FIG. 3) or a rod shape, the director of the liquid crystal molecules **1031** may be a long axis direction of the liquid crystal molecules.

(15) Specifically, a cross section of the groove **1021** perpendicular to the base **101** has a symmetrical geometric shape on left and right sides, and a width of the cross section gradually increases in a direction away from the base **101**. In an embodiment, a shape of the above-mentioned cross-section may specifically be an isosceles trapezoid (as shown in FIG. 1), a U-shape, or a circular arc shape with a central angle of not greater than 180 degrees.

(16) The number of the aforementioned grooves **1021** may be multiple, and the multiple grooves **1021** are arranged at equal intervals. In one embodiment, as shown in a in FIG. 4, the above-mentioned groove **1021** may be specifically a strip-shaped groove, and when the number of grooves **1021** is multiple, the multiple strip-shaped grooves **1021** may be arranged in parallel at equal intervals to adjust the viewing angle of the light L in only one direction (for example, a horizontal direction X). In another embodiment, as shown in b in FIG. 4, when the number of grooves **1021** is multiple, the multiple grooves **1021** may include a first strip-shaped groove **10211** extending in a first direction (for example, the horizontal direction X) and a second strip-shaped groove **10212** extending in a second direction (for example, a vertical direction Y) to adjust the viewing angle of the light L in two directions (for example, the horizontal direction X and the vertical direction Y). In another embodiment, the above-mentioned groove **1021** may also be specifically a prism-shaped groove, and when the number of grooves **1021** is multiple, the multiple prism-shaped grooves may be arranged at equal intervals so as to adjust the viewing angle of light L in multiple directions.

(17) In a specific embodiment, as shown in FIG. 5, the viewing angle adjustment film structure **100** may further include a first electrode **104** and a second electrode **105**. The first electrode **104** is disposed between the base **101** and the isotropic optical material layer **102**. The second electrode **105** is disposed on a side of the liquid crystal layer **103** away from the isotropic optical material layer **102**. Material of the first electrode **104** and material of the second electrode **105** may be a transparent conductive oxide such as indium tin oxide (ITO) or indium titanium oxynitride, or a transparent conductive metal such as silver or copper. In addition, the first electrode **104** and the second electrode **105** can provide the liquid crystal layer **103** with an externally applied voltage or electric field.

(18) Specifically, as shown in FIG. 6, the above-mentioned viewing angle adjustment film structure **100** may further include a first alignment film **106** and a second alignment film **107**. The first alignment film **106** is disposed between the isotropic optical material layer **102** and the liquid crystal layer **103**. The second alignment film **107** is disposed between the liquid crystal layer **103** and the second electrode **105**. The first alignment film **106** and the second alignment film **107** may be organic (such as polyimide) or inorganic (such as SiO₂) alignment films, and the external voltage or electric field is zero, that is, when there is no voltage or electric field is applied to the liquid crystal layer **103**, the director of the liquid crystal molecules **1031** can be made parallel to the base **101**, wherein a surface of the base **101** is parallel to the horizontal direction.

(19) Moreover, when the voltage applied to the first electrode **104** and the second electrode **105** gradually increases, the director of the liquid crystal molecules **1031** in the liquid crystal layer **103** will gradually deflect from a direction parallel to the base to a direction perpendicular to the base. At the same time, the refractive index of the liquid crystal layer **103** will gradually decrease. Specifically, when the angle between the director of the liquid crystal molecules **1031** and the substrate **101** is θ , an equivalent refractive index $n_{\text{sub.eff}}$ of the liquid crystal layer **103** can be calculated according to the following formula:

(20)
$$n_{\text{eff}} = \frac{n_e n_o}{\sqrt{n_o^2 + (n_e^2 - n_o^2) \sin^2(\theta)}}$$
 $n_{\text{sub.o}}$ is o light refractive index of the liquid crystal molecules, and $n_{\text{sub.e}}$ is e light refractive index of the liquid crystal molecules.

(21) For a specific example, as shown in FIG. 7, the above-mentioned liquid crystal layer **103** may include a base **1032** and a protrusion **1033** on the base **1032**. Shape and size of the protrusion **1033** match shape and size of the groove **1021** on the isotropic light material layer **102** described above. The protrusion **1033** may be obtained by filling the above-mentioned groove **1021** with liquid crystal material. Specifically, the cross-sectional shape of the protrusion **1033** perpendicular to the base **101** may be an isosceles trapezoid. An upper side length W_1 , a lower side length W_2 , and a height H_1 of the isosceles trapezoid may be 9.56 μm , 15.12 μm , and 16.67 μm , respectively. The separation distance between two adjacent protrusions **1031** may be 8-15 μm . In this example, when the material of the liquid crystal layer **103** is an E7 liquid crystal material, the o light refractive index $n_{\text{sub.o}}$ of the liquid crystal molecules **1031** in the liquid crystal layer **103** is 1.517, and the e light refractive index $n_{\text{sub.e}}$ is 1.741. In some embodiments, a thickness of the aforementioned isotropic optical material layer **102** may range from 5 to 100 μm . A thickness of the liquid crystal layer **103** may range from 5 to 20 μm , for example, 18.8 μm . In addition, in order to avoid leakage of liquid crystal molecules **1031** in the liquid crystal layer **103**, a thickness of the isotropic optical material layer **102** may be greater than the thickness of the liquid crystal layer **103**, for example, a ratio of the two may be greater than or equal to 2. The thickness of the liquid crystal layer **103** and the thickness of the isotropic optical material layer **102** both refer to a thickness of a region with the largest thickness in the corresponding film layer.

(22) Further, when the voltage applied to the first electrode **104** and the second electrode **105** gradually increases in the order of 2V, 3V, 4V, and 5V, the director of the liquid crystal molecules **1031** in the liquid crystal layer **103** changes from a direction parallel to the base **101**. The angle at which the direction is deflected in the direction perpendicular to the base **101** will gradually increase. Moreover, when the voltage applied to the first electrode **104** and the second electrode **105** is greater than or equal to 5V, the director of the liquid crystal molecules **1031** in the liquid crystal layer **103** can be made perpendicular to the base **101**. It should be noted that the externally applied voltage required for the deflection of the director of the liquid crystal molecules in the base **1032** that is not covered by the protrusions **1033** in the liquid crystal layer **103** is relatively high. The externally applied voltage required for the deflection of the director of the liquid crystal molecules in the protrusion **1033** is relatively low. Therefore, in this application, the director of the liquid crystal molecules **1031** in the liquid crystal layer **103** perpendicular to the base **101** can mean that the director of the liquid crystal molecules in the protrusion **1033** is perpendicular to the base

101. The director of the liquid crystal molecules in the base **1032** in the liquid crystal layer **103** that is not covered by the protrusions **1033** remains unchanged, that is, parallel to the base **101**.

(23) In specific implementation, corresponding director data (for example, the angle between the director of the liquid crystal molecules **1031** and the substrate **101**) can be determined according to simulation results of the director of the liquid crystal molecules **1031** in the liquid crystal layer **103** under different external applied voltages. Furthermore, the equivalent refractive index $n_{\text{sub. eff}}$ of the liquid crystal layer **103** under different externally applied voltages is calculated. Following the previous example, when the voltage applied to the first electrode **104** and the second electrode **105** gradually increases in the order of 2V, 3V, 4V, 5V, refractive index difference between the isotropic light material layer **102** and the liquid crystal layer **103** in the above-mentioned viewing angle adjustment film structure **100** will become larger and larger, and the refractive index difference will become larger and larger, corresponding viewing angle adjustment ability of the above-mentioned viewing angle adjustment film structure **100** to the incident light L is getting stronger. It should be noted that under ideal circumstances, when the externally applied voltage is 0, the refractive index difference between the liquid crystal layer **103** and the isotropic light material layer **102** in the viewing angle adjustment film structure **100** is zero (not shown in the figure).

(24) In the above embodiment, referring to FIG. 6, the viewing angle adjustment film structure **100** may further include a supporting pad **108**. The supporting pad **108** is disposed between the isotropic optical material layer **102** and the second electrode **105** and penetrates the liquid crystal layer **103**. This can precisely control thickness of the viewing angle adjustment film structure and ensure thickness uniformity of the viewing angle adjustment film structure. Specifically, hardness of the supporting pad **108** is generally greater than hardness of the isotropic optical material layer **102**, and its material may be an organic resin material or an inorganic insulating material. Moreover, when the first alignment film **106** is provided between the isotropic optical material layer **102** and the liquid crystal layer **103**, the supporting pad **108** may be specifically arranged between the first alignment film **106** and the isotropic optical material layer **102**. Alternatively, the supporting pad **108** may also be disposed between the isotropic optical material layer **102** and the second electrode **105**, and may penetrate the first alignment film **106** and the liquid crystal layer **103** at the same time.

(25) Compared with the prior art, the viewing angle adjustment film structure provided by the embodiment includes a base, an isotropic optical material layer, and a liquid crystal layer stacked in sequence, the isotropic optical material layer is provided with grooves, the liquid crystal layer fills the grooves, and light enters from the liquid crystal layer and then exits through the isotropic optical material layer. Director of liquid crystal molecules in the liquid crystal layer is changed according to an external applied voltage or a change of an electric field so as to adjust a viewing angle of the light emitted from the isotropic optical material layer. When the director is parallel to the base, a refractive index of the liquid crystal layer is the same as a refractive index of the isotropic optical material layer; when the director is perpendicular to the base, the refractive index of the liquid crystal layer is less than the refractive index of the isotropic optical material layer. Therefore, the viewing angle adjustment film structure can be used to replace a current viewing angle diffusion film, so as to solve an issue of display image quality when viewing the display panel from the front viewing angle due to reduction of display brightness and contrast of the front viewing angle of the display panel, resulting in deterioration of display quality when viewing the display panel from the front viewing angle.

(26) Referring to FIG. 8, FIG. 8 is a schematic flowchart of a manufacturing method of a viewing angle adjustment film structure provided by an embodiment of the present application. The manufacturing method of the viewing angle adjustment film structure includes the following steps.

(27) **S61**: providing a base.

(28) The base may be a transparent flexible base such as a polyimide or polysiloxane base, or a transparent rigid base such as a glass or plastic base.

(29) **S62**: forming an isotropic optical material layer on the base, wherein the isotropic optical material layer is provided with grooves.

(30) Material of the isotropic optical material layer may be UV curable resin or thermosetting resin such as epoxy resin, acrylic resin, urethane resin, silicone resin, or phenol resin. A cross section of the groove perpendicular to the base has a symmetrical geometric shape on left and right sides, and a width of the cross section gradually increases in a direction away from the base. In an embodiment, a shape of the above-mentioned cross-section may specifically be an isosceles trapezoid, a U-shape, or a circular arc shape with a central angle of not greater than 180 degrees.

(31) In details, the number of the aforementioned grooves may be multiple, and the multiple grooves are arranged at equal intervals. In one embodiment, the above-mentioned groove may be specifically a strip-shaped groove, and when the number of grooves is multiple, the multiple strip-shaped grooves may be arranged in parallel at equal intervals to adjust the viewing angle of the light in only one direction (for example, a horizontal direction). In another embodiment, when the number of grooves is multiple, the multiple grooves may include a first strip-shaped groove extending in a first direction (for example, the horizontal direction) and a second strip-shaped groove extending in a second direction (for example, a vertical direction) to adjust the viewing angle of the light in two directions (for example, the horizontal direction and the vertical direction). In another embodiment, the above-mentioned groove may also be specifically a prism-shaped groove, and when the number of grooves is multiple, the multiple prism-shaped grooves may be arranged at equal intervals so as to adjust the viewing angle of light in multiple directions.

(32) In specific implementation, an isotropic optical material can be coated on the base to obtain an initial layer. Grooves are embossed on an upper surface of the initial layer. Then, the initial layer is cured by ultraviolet light or heating to obtain an isotropic optical material layer.

(33) **S63**: forming a liquid crystal layer on the isotropic optical material layer, wherein the liquid crystal layer fills the grooves, light enters from the liquid crystal layer and then exits through the isotropic optical material layer; wherein director of liquid crystal molecules in the liquid crystal layer is changed according to an external applied voltage or a change of an electric field, so as to adjust a viewing angle of the light emitted from the isotropic optical material layer; when the director is parallel to the base, a refractive index of the liquid crystal layer is the same as a refractive index of the isotropic optical material layer, when the director is perpendicular to the base, the refractive index of the liquid crystal layer is less than the refractive index of the isotropic optical material layer.

(34) Specifically, when the director of the liquid crystal molecules **1031** in the liquid crystal layer **103** is parallel to the base **101**, as shown in FIG. 2, a refractive index of the liquid crystal layer **103** is the same as a refractive index of the isotropic optical material layer **102**. The corresponding light L entering from the liquid crystal layer **103** will not be refracted at an interface of the isotropic optical material layer **102**, that is, the viewing angle adjustment film structure **100** will not affect brightness and contrast of the light L at a front viewing angle. Further, when the director of the liquid crystal molecules **1031** in the liquid crystal layer **103** is not perpendicular to the base **101**, as shown in FIG. 3, the refractive index of the liquid crystal layer **102** is smaller than the refractive index of the isotropic optical material layer **102**. Correspondingly, at least part of the light L (for example, incident light at a front viewing angle) incident from the liquid crystal layer **103** will be refracted at the interface of the isotropic optical material layer **103**. Therefore, at least part of the incident light from the front viewing angle can be adjusted to light with a large viewing angle, so as to enhance brightness of the light under the large viewing angle. During specific implementation, a suitable external applied voltage or electric field can be selected according to actual use scene requirements of the above-mentioned viewing angle adjustment film structure **100**. The viewing angle adjustment film structure **100** uses a viewing angle to increase brightness of the light L at a large viewing angle by sacrificing brightness and contrast of the light L at a front viewing angle. Alternatively, the viewing angle adjustment film structure **100** is not used to increase the brightness

of the light L at a large viewing angle, thereby ensuring that the brightness and contrast of the light L at a front viewing angle are not reduced. In this way, the viewing angle adjustment film structure **100** in the present application can cope with the requirements of a complex use environment.

(35) Material of the liquid crystal layer **103** can be a nematic liquid crystal material or a blue phase liquid crystal material. Moreover, when shape of the liquid crystal molecules **1031** in the liquid crystal layer **103** is an elliptical sphere (as shown in FIG. 3) or a rod shape, the director of the liquid crystal molecules **1031** may be a long axis direction of the liquid crystal molecules.

(36) In an embodiment, before **S62**, it may further include:

(37) **S64**: forming a first electrode on the base.

(38) The above **S62** may include: forming an isotropic optical material layer on the base on which the first electrode is formed.

(39) The manufacturing method of the viewing angle adjustment film structure further comprises:

(40) **S65**: forming a second electrode on a substrate.

(41) The substrate may be a transparent flexible base such as a polyimide or polysiloxane base, or a transparent rigid base such as a glass or plastic base.

(42) **S66**: the second electrode is fixed on the liquid crystal layer through the substrate, the second electrode is disposed between the liquid crystal layer and the isotropic optical material layer, and the external applied voltage or the electric field is provided to the liquid crystal layer through the first electrode and the second electrode.

(43) Material of the first electrode **104** and material of the second electrode **105** may be a transparent conductive oxide such as indium tin oxide (ITO) or indium titanium oxynitride, or a transparent conductive metal such as silver or copper. In addition, in specific implementation, a frame sealant may be provided between an edge area of the base and an edge area of the substrate to bond the substrate to the base, so that the second electrode can be fixed on the liquid crystal layer.

(44) In a specific embodiment, before the foregoing **S63**, it may further include:

(45) **S67**: forming a first alignment film on the isotropic optical material layer, wherein the first alignment film is disposed between the isotropic optical material layer and the liquid crystal layer.

(46) And, before the above **S66**, it may also include:

(47) **S68**: forming a second alignment film on the second electrode, wherein the second alignment film is disposed between the liquid crystal layer and the second electrode.

(48) The first alignment film and the second alignment film may be organic (such as polyimide) or inorganic (such as SiO₂) alignment films, and the external voltage or electric field is zero, that is, when there is no voltage or electric field is applied to the liquid crystal layer, the director of the liquid crystal molecules can be made parallel to the base, wherein a surface of the base is parallel to the horizontal direction.

(49) In some embodiments, before the foregoing **S66**, it may further include:

(50) **S69**: forming a supporting pad on the isotropic optical material layer, wherein the supporting pad is disposed between the isotropic optical material layer and the second electrode, and the supporting pad penetrates the liquid crystal layer.

(51) In an embodiment, hardness of the supporting pad is generally greater than hardness of the isotropic optical material layer, and its material may be an organic resin material or an inorganic insulating material. Moreover, when the first alignment film is provided between the isotropic optical material layer and the liquid crystal layer, the supporting pad may be specifically arranged between the first alignment film and the isotropic optical material layer. Alternatively, the supporting pad may also be disposed between the isotropic optical material layer and the second electrode, and may penetrate the first alignment film and the liquid crystal layer at the same time. In this way, the thickness of the viewing angle adjustment film structure can be precisely controlled by the supporting pad, and the thickness uniformity of the viewing angle adjustment film structure can be ensured.

(52) Compared with the prior art, the manufacturing method of the viewing angle adjustment film structure provided by the embodiment includes providing a base, forming an isotropic optical material layer on the base, wherein the isotropic optical material layer is provided with grooves, and forming a liquid crystal layer on the isotropic optical material layer, wherein the liquid crystal layer fills the grooves. Light enters from the liquid crystal layer and then exits through the isotropic optical material layer. Director of liquid crystal molecules in the liquid crystal layer is changed according to an external applied voltage or a change of an electric field so as to adjust a viewing angle of the light emitted from the isotropic optical material layer. When the director is parallel to the base, a refractive index of the liquid crystal layer is the same as a refractive index of the isotropic optical material layer; when the director is perpendicular to the base, the refractive index of the liquid crystal layer is less than the refractive index of the isotropic optical material layer. Therefore, the viewing angle adjustment film structure can be used to replace a current viewing angle diffusion film, so as to solve an issue of display image quality when viewing the display panel from the front viewing angle due to reduction of display brightness and contrast of the front viewing angle of the display panel, resulting in deterioration of display quality when viewing the display panel from the front viewing angle.

(53) Referring to FIG. 9, FIG. 9 is a schematic structural diagram of a display device provided by an embodiment of the present application. The display device **80** includes the viewing angle adjustment film structure **81** of any of the above embodiments and a display panel **82**. The viewing angle adjustment film structure **81** is disposed on a light emitting surface **82A** of the display panel **82**, and a viewing angle of light emitted from the light emitting surface **82A** is adjusted by the viewing angle adjustment film structure **81**, so as to realize a front viewing angle display and a large viewing angle display of the display panel **82**.

(54) In details, the viewing angle adjustment film structure **81** may comprise a base, an isotropic optical material layer, and a liquid crystal layer stacked in sequence. The isotropic optical material layer is provided with grooves, the liquid crystal layer fills the grooves, and light enters from the liquid crystal layer and then exits through the isotropic optical material layer; wherein director of liquid crystal molecules in the liquid crystal layer is changed according to an external applied voltage or a change of an electric field, so as to adjust a viewing angle of the light emitted from the isotropic optical material layer. When the director is parallel to the base, a refractive index of the liquid crystal layer is the same as a refractive index of the isotropic optical material layer; when the director is perpendicular to the base, the refractive index of the liquid crystal layer is less than the refractive index of the isotropic optical material layer.

(55) In a specific embodiment, continuing to refer to FIG. 9, the above-mentioned display panel **82** may include a color filter substrate **821**, an array substrate **822** arranged opposite to the color filter substrate **821** and provided with a plurality of pixel units, and a liquid crystal material layer **823** filled between the color filter substrate **821** and the array substrate **822**, a first polarizer **824** disposed on a side of the color filter substrate **821** away from the liquid crystal material layer **823**, and a second polarizer **825** disposed on a side of the array substrate **822** away from the liquid crystal material layer **823**. The viewing angle adjustment film structure **81** is disposed on a side of the first polarizer **824** away from the color filter substrate **821**, and light emitted by the pixel units in the array substrate **822** exits through the liquid crystal material layer **823**, the color filter substrate **821**, the first polarizer **824**, the base, the liquid crystal layer, and the isotropic light material layer in sequence.

(56) The large viewing angle display of the display panel **82** corresponds to an application scenario where multiple people watch the display panel. In this case, a sufficiently large external applied voltage or electric field can be provided to the liquid crystal layer in the viewing angle adjustment film structure **81**. This enables the director of the liquid crystal molecules in the liquid crystal layer to be deflected by a preset angle from a direction parallel to the substrate to a direction perpendicular to the substrate. The larger the preset angle, the larger the external applied voltage or

electric field that needs to be provided to the liquid crystal layer, and the greater the refractive index difference between the liquid crystal layer and the isotropic optical material layer. The above-mentioned viewing angle adjustment film structure **81** has a stronger ability to adjust the viewing angle of the light emitted from the light emitting surface **82A** of the display panel **82**. During specific implementation, the externally applied voltage or electric field provided to the liquid crystal layer can be dynamically adjusted according to a real-time requirement of the viewing angle when viewing the display panel. This can realize real-time adjustment of the viewing angle of the emitted light. For example, when the required viewing angle becomes larger, the externally applied voltage or electric field provided to the liquid crystal layer can be increased. In this way, it is beneficial to improve a user viewing experience of the display panel.

(57) The front-view display of the display panel **82** corresponds to an application scenario where a single person views the display panel. In this case, it can be considered that there is no need to increase brightness of the light emitted from the light emitting surface **82A** at a large viewing angle. That is, there is no need to provide an externally applied voltage or electric field to the liquid crystal layer. Or the supplied externally applied voltage or electric field is zero. Therefore, it can be ensured that the viewing angle adjustment film structure **81** will not affect the brightness and contrast of the light emitted from the light emitting surface **82A** at a front viewing angle, thereby solving the issue of deterioration of display quality when viewing the display panel from a front viewing angle.

(58) Different from the prior art, in the display device of this embodiment, by providing a viewing angle adjustment film structure on the light emitting surface of the display panel, the viewing angle adjustment film structure can be used to replace a current viewing angle diffusion film. This can solve the issue of deterioration of display image quality when viewing the display panel from the front viewing angle due to reduction of the front viewing angle display brightness and the front viewing angle contrast of the display panel by the current viewing angle diffusion film.

(59) The above descriptions are only preferred embodiments of the present application and are not intended to limit the present application. Any modification, equivalent replacement, and improvement made within the spirit and principle of the present application shall be included in the protection scope of the present application.

Claims

1. A viewing angle adjustment film structure, comprising: a base, an isotropic optical material layer, and a liquid crystal layer stacked in sequence, wherein the isotropic optical material layer is provided with grooves, and the liquid crystal layer fills the grooves, so that light enters from the liquid crystal layer and then exits through the isotropic optical material layer; wherein a director of liquid crystal molecules in the liquid crystal layer is changed according to a change of an externally applied voltage or electric field, so as to adjust a viewing angle of the light exiting from the isotropic optical material layer; wherein when the director is parallel to the base, a refractive index of the liquid crystal layer is the same as a refractive index of the isotropic optical material layer; when the director is perpendicular to the base, the refractive index of the liquid crystal layer is less than the refractive index of the isotropic optical material layer; and wherein the viewing angle adjustment film structure further comprises: a first electrode and a second electrode, wherein the first electrode is disposed between the base and the isotropic optical material layer, the second electrode is arranged on a side of the liquid crystal layer away from the isotropic optical material layer, and the externally applied voltage or electric field is provided to the liquid crystal layer through the first electrode and the second electrode; a first alignment film and a second alignment film, wherein the first alignment film is disposed between the isotropic optical material layer and the liquid crystal layer, and the second alignment film is disposed between the liquid crystal layer and the second electrode; and a supporting pad disposed between the isotropic optical material

- layer and the second electrode to penetrate the first alignment film and the liquid crystal layer.
2. The viewing angle adjustment film structure according to claim 1, wherein the liquid crystal layer comprises a base part and protrusions on the base part, and a cross-sectional shape of each of the protrusions perpendicular to the base part is an isosceles trapezoid, and the grooves are arranged at equal intervals.
 3. The viewing angle adjustment film structure according to claim 2, wherein the grooves are strip-shaped grooves arranged at equal intervals in parallel.
 4. The viewing angle adjustment film structure according to claim 1, wherein a cross section of each of the grooves perpendicular to the base is a geometric shape with symmetrical left and right sides, and has a width gradually increasing in a direction away from the base.
 5. The viewing angle adjustment film structure according to claim 4, wherein the cross section of each of the grooves perpendicular to the base is an isosceles trapezoid, a U-shape, or a circular arc with a central angle not greater than 180 degrees.
 6. A method of manufacturing a viewing angle adjustment film structure, comprising: providing a base; forming a first electrode on the base; forming an isotropic optical material layer on the first electrode, wherein the isotropic optical material layer is provided with grooves; forming a first alignment film on the isotropic optical material layer; forming a liquid crystal layer on the first alignment film, wherein the liquid crystal layer fills the grooves, so that light enters from the liquid crystal layer and then exits through the isotropic optical material layer; forming a supporting pad on the isotropic optical material layer, wherein the supporting pad is disposed to penetrate the first alignment film and the liquid crystal layer; forming a second electrode on a substrate; forming a second alignment film on the second electrode; and disposing the second alignment film and the second electrode on the liquid crystal layer through the substrate, so that the liquid crystal layer and the supporting pad are disposed between the second electrode and the isotropic optical material layer, and an externally applied voltage or electric field is provided to the liquid crystal layer through the first electrode and the second electrode, wherein a director of liquid crystal molecules in the liquid crystal layer is changed according to a change of the externally applied voltage or electric field, so as to adjust a viewing angle of the light exiting from the isotropic optical material layer; and wherein when the director is parallel to the base, a refractive index of the liquid crystal layer is the same as a refractive index of the isotropic optical material layer; when the director is perpendicular to the base, the refractive index of the liquid crystal layer is less than the refractive index of the isotropic optical material layer.
 7. The method according to claim 6, wherein the liquid crystal layer comprises a base part and protrusions on the base part, and a cross-sectional shape of each of the protrusions perpendicular to the base part is an isosceles trapezoid.
 8. A display device, comprising: a viewing angle adjustment film structure and a display panel, wherein the viewing angle adjustment film structure is disposed on a light emitting surface of the display panel, so that a viewing angle of light emitted from the light emitting surface is adjusted by the viewing angle adjustment film structure; wherein the viewing angle adjustment film structure comprises a base, an isotropic optical material layer, and a liquid crystal layer stacked in sequence, wherein the isotropic optical material layer is provided with grooves, and the liquid crystal layer fills the grooves, so that light enters from the liquid crystal layer and then exits through the isotropic optical material layer; wherein a director of liquid crystal molecules in the liquid crystal layer is changed according to a change of an externally applied voltage or electric field, so as to adjust a viewing angle of the light exiting from the isotropic optical material layer; wherein when the director is parallel to the base, a refractive index of the liquid crystal layer is the same as a refractive index of the isotropic optical material layer; when the director is perpendicular to the base, the refractive index of the liquid crystal layer is less than the refractive index of the isotropic optical material layer; and wherein the viewing angle adjustment film structure further comprises: a first electrode and a second electrode, wherein the first electrode is disposed between the base and

the isotropic optical material layer, the second electrode is arranged on a side of the liquid crystal layer away from the isotropic optical material layer, and the externally applied voltage or electric field is provided to the liquid crystal layer through the first electrode and the second electrode; a first alignment film and a second alignment film, wherein the first alignment film is disposed between the isotropic optical material layer and the liquid crystal layer, and the second alignment film is disposed between the liquid crystal layer and the second electrode; and a supporting pad disposed between the isotropic optical material layer and the second electrode to penetrate the first alignment film and the liquid crystal layer.

9. The display device according to claim 8, wherein the liquid crystal layer comprises a base part and protrusions on the base part, and a cross-sectional shape of each of the protrusions perpendicular to the base part is an isosceles trapezoid, and the grooves are arranged at equal intervals.

10. The display device according to claim 9, wherein the grooves are strip-shaped grooves arranged at equal intervals in parallel.

11. The display device according to claim 8, wherein the display panel comprises a color filter substrate, an array substrate arranged opposite to the color filter substrate and provided with a plurality of pixel units, a liquid crystal material layer disposed between the color filter substrate and the array substrate, a first polarizer disposed on a side of the color filter substrate away from the liquid crystal material layer, and a second polarizer disposed on a side of the array substrate away from the liquid crystal material layer, wherein the viewing angle adjustment film structure is disposed on a side of the first polarizer away from the color filter substrate, and light emitted by the pixel units in the array substrate exits through the liquid crystal material layer, the color filter substrate, the first polarizer, the liquid crystal layer, the isotropic optical material layer, and the base in sequence.

12. The display device according to claim 8, wherein a cross section of each of the grooves perpendicular to the base is a geometric shape with symmetrical left and right sides, and has a width gradually increasing in a direction away from the base.

13. The display device according to claim 12, wherein the cross section of each of the grooves perpendicular to the base is an isosceles trapezoid, a U-shape, or a circular arc with a central angle not greater than 180 degrees.
